

DINNER · POPPY'S KITCHEN

Pork Carnitas Tacos

Slow cooker does the work all day; a quick broil at the end makes the edges crispy.

4, plus 2 lunches	8 hr 30
SERVES	START TO TABLE
20 min	**8 hr 10**
PREP	COOK

Set it in the morning

🛒 What you need

FROM THE STORE

- ☐ **3–4 lb** Boneless pork shoulder
- ☐ **1 cup** Orange juice
- ☐ **3** Limes
- ☐ **1** Onion, quartered
- ☐ **6 cloves** Garlic
- ☐ **12** Mission soft taco tortillas
- ☐ **1 bunch** Cilantro
- ☐ **1 jar** Herdez salsa verde
- ☐ **2** Avocados

FROM THE PANTRY

- ☐ **1 Tbsp** Salt
- ☐ **2 tsp** Cumin
- ☐ **2 tsp** Dried oregano
- ☐ **1 tsp** Chili powder
- ☐ **2** Bay leaves

⚡ **First:** Start the slow cooker in the morning (8 hours on low).

GEAR

Slow cooker · Sheet pan · Two forks

🔥 Let's cook

1. Morning: cut the pork into 4 big chunks. Rub with salt, cumin, oregano and chili powder. ⏱️ 10 min
2. Put the onion and garlic in the slow cooker, pork on top. Pour in the orange juice and the juice of 2 limes; add bay leaves. 🧒 Kids can do this
3. Cook on LOW 8 hours (or HIGH 5) until it falls apart. ⏱️ 8 hr
4. Dinner: shred the pork with two forks right in the pot; toss with the juices.
5. Spread on a sheet pan, spoon over ½ cup of the juices, and broil 5–7 minutes until the edges crisp. Watch it. ⏱️ 7 min
6. Warm the tortillas. Set out cilantro, chopped onion, lime wedges, salsa verde and avocado. 🧒 Kids can do this
7. Build tacos. Save leftovers in some of the juice so they stay moist.



CHEF'S SECRET

The broil at the end is everything: crispy edges plus juicy middle is what makes it carnitas and not just pulled pork.

DINNER · FLIP SIDE

Pork Carnitas Tacos

👩‍🍳 Kitchen crew: kid jobs

- [ ] Squeeze the limes and pour in the juice
- [ ] Slice avocado (butter knife works)
- [ ] Pick cilantro leaves
- [ ] Set up the taco bar

Knives, the stove and the oven: a grown-up stays right there. Steps marked 🧒 **Kids can do this** on the front are theirs to own.

⏰ MAKE IT AHEAD

Cook the pork up to 3 days ahead; broil right before dinner.

🥡 LEFTOVERS

Freezes great in its juices. Carnitas bowls, quesadillas or nachos later in the week.

🔁 SWAP IT

- Instant Pot: 60 minutes on high, natural release
- Corn tortillas, charred over the flame

🍽️ SERVE IT WITH

Black beans, Minute rice with lime, or street corn

⏱️ Game plan: everything lands at once

Morning	Season the pork; kids load onion, garlic and juices in the cooker.
8 hr	Slow cooker on LOW (or HIGH 5 hr) and leave it alone.
20 min out	Shred the pork right in the pot with the juices.
15 min	Spread on a sheet pan and broil until crisp. Watch it.
10 min	Kids warm tortillas and set out the taco bar.
Dinner	Build tacos; save leftovers in some juice.

Done cooking? Tell Poppy how it went.

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Poppy's draft. Change something? Tell Poppy with 💡 so the card learns.